

Chapter 2 — Nationalism in India

The one-line point: This chapter is **not a chronology of the freedom struggle**. It is an argument about **why the freedom struggle was hard to hold together** — because *"each class and group felt the effects of colonialism differently... and their notions of freedom were not always the same."* Everyone answered the call of **swaraj**; almost nobody meant the same thing by it. **Master that one idea and this chapter carries you further in Mains than any other in the NCERT History series.**

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Syllabus Classification

Field	Value
Subject	History → Modern India / the Freedom Struggle
Sub-discipline	Political history · social history of a mass movement · the making of national identity
Period	1915 – 1947 (core: 1919–1934)
Prelims (GS Paper I)	★★★★ Rowlatt Act, Jallianwala Bagh, Khilafat, Chauri Chaura, Simon Commission, Lahore 1929, Dandi, Gandhi–Irwin, Poona Pact, Quit India — all standard Prelims fare, and all here
Mains (GS Paper I)	★★★★★ "The Freedom Struggle — its various stages and important contributors/contributions from different parts of the country" is a syllabus line, and this chapter is the best short account of it you will read
Also feeds	Indian Society ★★★★★ (caste, the Poona Pact, women's participation and its limits, communal divergence), Polity ★★★★★ (separate electorates → reservation ; the Poona Pact is the origin of SC reservation), Ethics ★★★★★ (satyagraha; means and ends; Gandhi's fast unto death), Essay ★★★★★ (unity in diversity; leadership; symbols)
Weightage	★★★★★ — the single most examinable chapter in the series
Overlaps with	★★★★★ Class 8 Ch.8 (the movement up to 1919 — <i>read that first, this chapter picks up from the 1920s</i>), Ch.1 of this book (<i>"European ideas of nationalism were nowhere replicated"</i>), Class 9 supplement (khadi, Swadeshi, Gandhi's dress), Class 9 Ch.4 (forest laws — the Gudam rebellion)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

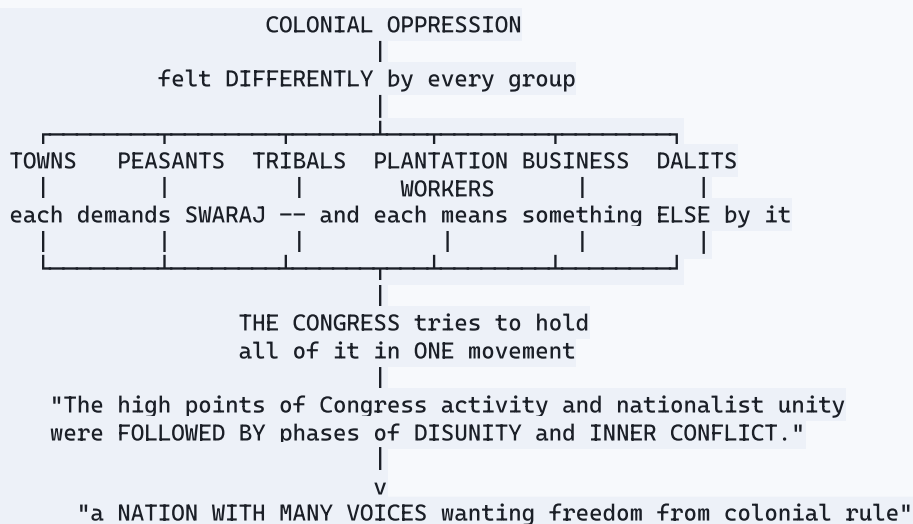
- ☐ **Explain how the First World War created the conditions** for a mass movement, with figures. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Define satyagraha** in Gandhi's own terms and explain why he called it **active**, not passive. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Name the three early satyagrahas** — Champaran, Ahmedabad, Kheda — with years and causes. ★★★★★
- ☐ **State what the Rowlatt Act did** and narrate Jallianwala Bagh and its aftermath. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain why Gandhi took up the Khilafat issue.** ★★★★★
- ☐ **Give the *Hind Swaraj* argument** for why non-cooperation would work. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Describe the staged programme** of Non-Cooperation, and the internal Congress tussle. ★★★★★

- ☐ ★★★★★ Explain how FIVE different groups understood swaraj differently — townspeople, Awadh peasants, Gudum tribals, plantation workers, and later the rich peasants, poor tenants, business classes, workers, women, dalits and Muslims.
- ☐ Explain why the town movement slowed, in two specific ways. ★★★★★
- ☐ Explain why Gandhi withdrew Non-Cooperation. ★★★★★
- ☐ Narrate the road to Civil Disobedience — Swaraj Party, Depression, Simon, Lahore, the eleven demands. ★★★★★
- ☐ ★★★★★ Explain why SALT was the perfect symbol.
- ☐ State how Civil Disobedience differed from Non-Cooperation. ★★★★★
- ☐ Explain the Ambedkar–Gandhi clash and the Poona Pact. ★★★★★
- ☐ Explain the sources of Muslim alienation, and state Iqbal's argument fairly. ★★★★★
- ☐ Explain how a sense of collective belonging was manufactured — Bharat Mata, folklore, flags, history. ★★★★★

The Framing — read this before anything else

★★★★★ *"In India and as in many other colonies, the growth of modern nationalism is **intimately connected to the anti-colonial movement. People began discovering their unity IN THE PROCESS of their struggle with colonialism.** The sense of being oppressed under colonialism **provided a shared bond** that tied many different groups together. **BUT EACH CLASS AND GROUP FELT THE EFFECTS OF COLONIALISM DIFFERENTLY, THEIR EXPERIENCES WERE VARIED, AND THEIR NOTIONS OF FREEDOM WERE NOT ALWAYS THE SAME.** The Congress under Mahatma Gandhi tried to **forge these groups together within one movement. BUT THE UNITY DID NOT EMERGE WITHOUT CONFLICT.**"*

THE ARGUMENT OF THIS CHAPTER, IN ONE DIAGRAM



🎯 **Every good Mains answer on the freedom struggle is built on this structure, not on dates.** A candidate who writes "*Non-Cooperation began in 1921 and was withdrawn after Chauri Chaura*" has written a timeline. A candidate who writes "*the Awadh peasant heard swaraj as the end of begar, the Gudam hill man as the return of his forest, the Assam plantation worker as the right to go home, and the industrialist as the end of trade restrictions — and the Congress had to hold all four together*" has written history. **Learn the groups.**

1 The War, Khilafat and Non-Cooperation

★ What the First World War did to India — ★★★★★

DEFENCE SPENDING

"a HUGE INCREASE in defence expenditure", financed by

WAR LOANS and INCREASING TAXES:

CUSTOMS DUTIES RAISED and INCOME TAX INTRODUCED

PRICES

"Through the war years prices increased -- DOUBLING BETWEEN 1913 AND 1918 -- leading to EXTREME HARDSHIP for the common people."

MANPOWER

"Villages were called upon to SUPPLY SOLDIERS, and the FORCED RECRUITMENT in rural areas caused WIDESPREAD ANGER."

FAMINE AND EPIDEMIC

"in 1918-19 and 1920-21, CROPS FAILED in many parts of India, resulting in ACUTE SHORTAGES OF FOOD. This was accompanied by an INFLUENZA EPIDEMIC."

"According to the CENSUS OF 1921, 12 TO 13 MILLION PEOPLE PERISHED as a result of famines and the epidemic."

"People HOPED that their hardships would end after the war was over. BUT THAT DID NOT HAPPEN."

Word: ★ Forced recruitment — "a process by which the colonial state forced people to join the army." 🎯 ★★★★★ **12-13 million dead is the figure to carry**, and it explains something a purely political account cannot: **why the countryside was available for mobilisation in 1921 in a way it had never been before.** The Congress of the 1880s addressed a public of lawyers and journalists; the Congress of 1921 addressed a population that had just buried a tenth of itself. (*Compare Class 9 Ch.2: the same war, the same doubling of prices, the same bread riots — and in Russia it produced a revolution.*)

👉 1.1 The idea of satyagraha ★★★★★

Gandhi returned to India in ★ January 1915, from South Africa where "*he had successfully fought the racist regime with a novel method of mass agitation, which he called satyagraha.*"

WHAT SATYAGRAHA CLAIMS

"emphasised the POWER OF TRUTH and the NEED TO SEARCH FOR TRUTH."

"IF THE CAUSE WAS TRUE, IF THE STRUGGLE WAS AGAINST INJUSTICE, THEN PHYSICAL FORCE WAS NOT NECESSARY TO FIGHT THE OPPRESSOR."

"Without seeking VENGEANCE or being AGGRESSIVE, a satyagrahi could win the battle THROUGH NON-VIOLENCE."

THE MECHANISM: "by APPEALING TO THE CONSCIENCE OF THE OPPRESSOR. People -- INCLUDING THE OPPRESSORS -- had to be PERSUADED TO SEE THE TRUTH, instead of being FORCED to accept truth through the use of violence."

"By this struggle, TRUTH WAS BOUND TO ULTIMATELY TRIUMPH."

"Mahatma Gandhi believed that THIS DHARMA OF NON-VIOLENCE COULD UNITE ALL INDIANS."

Source A — Gandhi's own words, and the distinction that matters: "It is said of 'passive resistance' that it is the weapon of the weak, but the power which is the subject of this article CAN BE USED ONLY BY THE STRONG. This power is NOT passive resistance; indeed IT CALLS FOR INTENSE ACTIVITY. The movement in South Africa was not passive but active... Satyagraha is not physical force. A satyagrahi does not inflict pain on the adversary; he does not seek his destruction... In the use of satyagraha, THERE IS NO ILL-WILL WHATEVER. Satyagraha is pure SOUL-FORCE. Truth is the very substance of the soul. That is why this force is called satyagraha... Non-violence is the supreme dharma... It is certain that India cannot rival Britain or Europe in FORCE OF ARMS. The British worship the war-god... **The hundreds of millions in India can NEVER carry arms. They have made the religion of non-violence their own...*"

🌀 ★★★★★ NCERT's own activity asks what Gandhi meant by "active resistance", and the answer is worth getting right because it is a standard Ethics question. Passive resistance is what you do when you **cannot** fight; satyagraha is what you do when you **choose not to**. The first is weakness dressed as principle; the second is "pure soul-force" requiring "intense activity". ★ And note the last paragraph is a strategic argument, not only a moral one — India could never match Britain in arms, so a method that does not depend on arms is the only one that can win. **Gandhi is claiming non-violence is both right and, for a disarmed people, the only thing that works.** (He makes the same double argument to Hitler — Class 9 Ch.3, Box 2.)

🌿 The three early satyagrahas — ★★★★★ know all three

Year	Place	Cause
★ 1917	CHAMPARAN, Bihar	"to inspire the peasants to struggle against the oppressive plantation system "
★ 1918	AHMEDABAD	"to organise a satyagraha movement amongst cotton mill workers "
★ 1918	KHEDA district, Gujarat	"Affected by crop failure and a plague epidemic , the peasants could not pay the revenue , and were demanding that revenue collection be relaxed "

🌀 Notice the spread: a plantation, a factory, a district of peasants. Within three years Gandhi had tested the method on **three entirely different constituencies** — and it is that portfolio, not any single victory, that made a nationwide satyagraha thinkable in 1919.

1.2 The Rowlatt Act and Jallianwala Bagh

Element	Detail
☆☆☆ What the Act did	"hurriedly passed through the Imperial Legislative Council DESPITE THE UNITED OPPOSITION of the Indian members . It gave the government enormous powers to repress political activities , and allowed DETENTION OF POLITICAL PRISONERS WITHOUT TRIAL FOR TWO YEARS "
★ The response	"Mahatma Gandhi wanted non-violent civil disobedience against such unjust laws , which would start with a HARTAL on 6 APRIL "
What happened	" Rallies were organised in various cities, workers went on strike in railway workshops , and shops closed down "
☆☆ Why the British panicked	"Alarmed by the popular upsurge, and scared that lines of communication such as the RAILWAYS AND TELEGRAPH would be disrupted , the British administration decided to clamp down" — local leaders picked up from Amritsar , Gandhi barred from entering Delhi
10 April	"the police in Amritsar fired upon a peaceful procession , provoking widespread attacks on banks, post offices and railway stations . Martial law was imposed and General Dyer took command "

13 APRIL 1919 -- JALLIANWALA BAGH

"a large crowd gathered in the ENCLOSED GROUND of Jallianwalla Bagh."

SOME came to PROTEST against the new repressive measures

OTHERS "had come to attend the ANNUAL BAISAKHI FAIR"

"Being from outside the city, MANY VILLAGERS WERE UNAWARE OF THE MARTIAL LAW that had been imposed."

"Dyer ENTERED THE AREA, BLOCKED THE EXIT POINTS, and OPENED FIRE on the crowd, KILLING HUNDREDS."

HIS OWN STATED OBJECT: "to PRODUCE A MORAL EFFECT, to create in the minds of satyagrahis A FEELING OF TERROR AND AWE."

And the aftermath — ☆☆☆ the humiliation is the point:

*"As the news spread, crowds took to the streets in many north Indian towns. There were **strikes, clashes with the police and attacks on government buildings**. The government responded with **brutal repression, SEEKING TO HUMILIATE AND TERRORISE people**: ☆ **satyagrahis were forced to RUB THEIR NOSES ON THE GROUND, CRAWL ON THE STREETS, and do SALAAM to all sahibs; people were FLOGGED and villages (around GUJRANWALA in Punjab, now in Pakistan) WERE BOMBED**. Seeing violence spread, Mahatma Gandhi called off the movement."*

 ☆☆☆☆ Dyer's phrase — "to produce a moral effect" — deserves a sentence of its own in **any answer**. He did not claim self-defence or accident. He was **teaching a lesson**, and the crawling orders that followed were the same lesson extended: **the point was not to punish acts but to enforce a posture**. (Compare the "shoe respect" rule in the Class 9 supplement — colonial authority repeatedly worked by prescribing how the body must be held.) **A regime that needs people on their knees has already lost the argument about consent**.

👤 Why Gandhi took up Khilafat — ★★★★★

THE PROBLEM

"While the Rowlatt satyagraha had been a widespread movement, it was still LIMITED MOSTLY TO CITIES AND TOWNS."
Gandhi "felt the need to launch a MORE BROAD-BASED movement."

THE CONDITION HE SET

"But he was CERTAIN that NO SUCH MOVEMENT COULD BE ORGANISED WITHOUT BRINGING THE HINDUS AND MUSLIMS CLOSER TOGETHER."

THE OPPORTUNITY

The First World War had ended with THE DEFEAT OF OTTOMAN TURKEY, and there were rumours of "a HARSH PEACE TREATY" on the Ottoman emperor -- "the SPIRITUAL HEAD of the Islamic world (the KHALIFA)."

MARCH 1919 -- a KHILAFAT COMMITTEE formed in BOMBAY "to defend the Khalifa's TEMPORAL POWERS."

Young Muslim leaders -- the brothers MUHAMMAD ALI and SHAUKAT ALI -- began discussing UNITED MASS ACTION with Gandhi.

SEPTEMBER 1920, the CALCUTTA SESSION of the Congress: Gandhi convinced other leaders "of the need to start a NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT IN SUPPORT OF KHILAFAT AS WELL AS FOR SWARAJ."

🎯 ★★★★★ **State the logic precisely, because it is often garbled.** Gandhi did not take up Khilafat because he had a view on the Ottoman Caliphate. He took it up because **a movement confined to Hindu townsmen could not be a national movement**, and Khilafat was the available issue on which Muslims were already mobilised. ⚠️ **It was also a strategy with a built-in expiry date** — an alliance resting on a *specific grievance* dissolves when the grievance does, and §3.3 below records exactly that: "*After the decline of the Non-Cooperation-Khilafat Movement, a large section of Muslims felt alienated from the Congress.*" **The best answers note both the achievement and the fragility.**

■ 1.3 Why non-cooperation? — the *Hind Swaraj* argument

★★★★★ **"In his famous book *Hind Swaraj* (1909) Mahatma Gandhi declared that **British rule was ESTABLISHED IN INDIA WITH THE COOPERATION OF INDIANS, and had SURVIVED ONLY BECAUSE OF THIS COOPERATION. IF INDIANS REFUSED TO COOPERATE, BRITISH RULE IN INDIA WOULD COLLAPSE WITHIN A YEAR, and swaraj would come.**"***

Word: ★ Boycott — "the refusal to deal and associate with people, or participate in activities, or buy and use things; usually a form of protest."

The staged programme:

STAGE 1 – SURRENDER OF TITLES that the government awarded
– BOYCOTT of CIVIL SERVICES, ARMY, POLICE, COURTS
and LEGISLATIVE COUNCILS, SCHOOLS, and FOREIGN
GOODS

STAGE 2 "Then, IN CASE THE GOVERNMENT USED REPRESSION, a
FULL CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE CAMPAIGN would be launched."

"Through the summer of 1920 Mahatma Gandhi and SHAUKAT ALI toured extensively, mobilising popular support."

The internal fight — ★★★★★ NCERT is honest about this and so should you be:

*"Many within the Congress were, however, **concerned about the proposals**. They were **reluctant to boycott the council elections scheduled for NOVEMBER 1920**, and they **feared that the movement might lead to popular violence**. In the months between **September and December** there was an **INTENSE TUSSLE** within the Congress. For a while **there seemed no meeting point** between the supporters and the opponents. Finally, at the ★★ **Congress session at NAGPUR in DECEMBER 1920**, a **COMPROMISE** was worked out and the **Non-Cooperation programme** was adopted."*

🎯 The insight in *Hind Swaraj* is worth stating plainly because it is the intellectual foundation of the whole method: a hundred thousand Britons could not physically hold three hundred million Indians. They did not need to — **Indians staffed the courts, the police, the army, the schools and the offices**. Colonial rule was therefore not something done *to* Indians so much as something done *through* them. ★ That reframing turns every ordinary person into a participant with the power to withdraw, which is precisely what makes a mass movement possible where a conspiracy or a petition could not be.

2 Differing Strands — ★★ ★★ ★★ ★★ THE CORE OF THE CHAPTER

*"The Non-Cooperation-Khilafat Movement began in **JANUARY 1921**. Various social groups participated, each with its own specific aspiration. ★★ All of them responded to the call of Swaraj, **BUT THE TERM MEANT DIFFERENT THINGS TO DIFFERENT PEOPLE**."*

🏠 2.1 The movement in the towns

Element	Detail
Who	"started with middle-class participation in the cities " — thousands of students left government schools and colleges, headmasters and teachers resigned, lawyers gave up their legal practices
★★ The exception	"The council elections were boycotted in most provinces EXCEPT MADRAS , where the JUSTICE PARTY , the party of the NON-BRAHMANS , felt that entering the council was one way of GAINING SOME POWER — something that usually only Brahmans had access to"
★★ The economic effect	Foreign goods boycotted , liquor shops picketed , foreign cloth burnt in huge bonfires . ★★★ The import of foreign cloth HALVED between 1921 and 1922, its value dropping from Rs 102 CRORE to Rs 57 CRORE . Merchants and traders refused to trade in foreign goods or finance foreign trade , and production of Indian textile mills and handlooms went up

Word: ★ Picket — "a form of demonstration or protest by which people block the entrance to a shop, factory or office."

🎯 ★★ ★★ ★★ The Justice Party's refusal is the first crack, and it is a very important one. For non-Brahmans in Madras, the council was **not** an instrument of colonial rule to be boycotted — it was **the only route to power in a society where Brahmans monopolised office**. ★ Boycotting the state looks different depending on whether the alternative is your own community's dominance or your own community's exclusion. This is exactly the logic that reappears with the **dalits** in §3.3, and it is the deepest tension in the whole national movement: **for the socially subordinated, the colonial state was sometimes a shield against Indian hierarchy**.

★★★ ★★ Why the town movement slowed — NCERT gives TWO precise reasons, and both are asked:

REASON 1 -- KHADI WAS TOO EXPENSIVE

"Khadi cloth was often MORE EXPENSIVE than mass-produced mill cloth and POOR PEOPLE COULD NOT AFFORD TO BUY IT.
HOW THEN COULD THEY BOYCOTT MILL CLOTH FOR TOO LONG?"

REASON 2 -- NO ALTERNATIVE INSTITUTIONS

"For the movement to be successful, ALTERNATIVE INDIAN INSTITUTIONS HAD TO BE SET UP so that they could be used in place of the British ones. THESE WERE SLOW TO COME UP.
So STUDENTS AND TEACHERS BEGAN TRICKLING BACK to government schools and LAWYERS JOINED BACK WORK in government courts."

🎯 ★★★★★ This is the practical limit of every boycott, and it generalises. You can ask people to **stop** doing something for a week; you cannot ask them to stop **indefinitely** unless you have built the replacement. **Boycott without construction is a movement with a clock running against it** — which is precisely why Gandhi's later programme put so much weight on **constructive work**: national schools, khadi production, village industry. (And note reason 1 is the same poverty objection that limited Swadeshi in 1905 — Class 9 supplement §5.1.)

🌿 2.2 Rebellion in the countryside — Awadh

Element	Detail
★★ The leader	BABA RAMCHANDRA — "a <i>sanyasi</i> who had earlier been to FIJI as an INDENTURED LABOURER "
Against whom	talukdars and landlords who demanded " exorbitantly high rents and a variety of other cesses "
★★ The grievances	Peasants " had to do <i>BEGAR</i> and work at landlords' farms <i>without any payment</i> "; as tenants " they had <i>NO SECURITY OF TENURE</i>, being <i>regularly evicted</i> so that they could <i>acquire no right over the leased land</i> "
★★★ The demands	reduction of revenue · abolition of begar · SOCIAL BOYCOTT of oppressive landlords
★★ The method	"In many places <i>nai-dhobi bandhs</i> were organised by panchayats to deprive landlords of the services of even <i>BARBERS AND WASHERMEN</i> "
Congress involvement	★ June 1920 — Jawaharlal Nehru began going around the villages in Awadh, " talking to the villagers, and trying to understand their grievances ". ★★ By October the OUDH KISAN SABHA was set up , headed by Nehru, Baba Ramchandra and a few others — " Within a month, over 300 branches had been set up "

Word: ★ Begar — "labour that villagers were forced to contribute without any payment."

★★★★★ **And then it escaped Congress control:**

*"The peasant movement, however, **developed in forms that the Congress leadership was UNHAPPY WITH**. As the movement spread in 1921, **the houses of talukdars and merchants were attacked, bazaars were looted, and grain hoards were taken over**. ★★ **In many places LOCAL LEADERS TOLD PEASANTS THAT GANDHIJI HAD DECLARED THAT NO TAXES WERE TO BE PAID AND LAND WAS TO BE REDISTRIBUTED AMONG THE POOR. THE NAME OF THE MAHATMA WAS BEING INVOKED TO SANCTION ALL ACTION AND ASPIRATIONS.**"*

★★★★★ **"The name of the Mahatma was being invoked to sanction all action and aspirations" is one of the most important sentences in the book.** Gandhi's authority travelled far beyond Gandhi's instructions. Peasants who had never seen him used his name to authorise **rent strikes and land redistribution he had never called for. A mass movement is not a chain of command; it is a name that people fill with their own hopes.** (Compare the Santhals who thought the Gandhi cap would stop bullets — Class 9 supplement, Box 4 — and the Pratapgarh peasants of Class 8 Ch.8.)

Source B — Nehru at Rae Bareilly, 6 January 1921, after the police fired on peasants. He was **stopped by the police** from reaching the site and addressed the crowd that gathered: **"They behaved as brave men, calm and unruffled in the face of danger. I do not know how they felt but I know what my feelings were.** ★ **For a moment MY BLOOD WAS UP, NON-VIOLENCE WAS ALMOST FORGOTTEN — but for a moment only.** The thought of the great leader... came to me, and **I saw the kisans seated and standing near me, LESS EXCITED, MORE PEACEFUL THAN I WAS — and the moment of weakness passed, I spoke to them in all humility on non-violence — ★★ I NEEDED THE LESSON MORE THAN THEY — and they heeded me and peacefully dispersed."** 🎯 **Read that admission carefully. The Cambridge-educated Congress leader records that the peasants were calmer than he was, and that he was the one who needed the lesson.** It is a rare piece of honesty from the leadership about who was actually disciplined — and it quietly corrects the assumption that non-violence flowed downward from the educated to the masses.

🗡️ **The Gudum hills — Alluri Sitaram Raju** ★★★★★

THE GRIEVANCE (and note it is a FOREST grievance)
"the colonial government had CLOSED LARGE FOREST AREAS, preventing people from ENTERING THE FORESTS TO GRAZE THEIR CATTLE, or to COLLECT FUELWOOD AND FRUITS."

"Not only were their livelihoods affected but THEY FELT THAT THEIR TRADITIONAL RIGHTS WERE BEING DENIED."

"When the government began FORCING THEM TO CONTRIBUTE BEGAR FOR ROAD BUILDING, the hill people revolted."

THE LEADER -- ALLURI SITARAM RAJU
He "claimed that he had a variety of SPECIAL POWERS: he could make CORRECT ASTROLOGICAL PREDICTIONS and HEAL PEOPLE, and he could SURVIVE EVEN BULLET SHOTS. Captivated by Raju, the rebels proclaimed that HE WAS AN INCARNATION OF GOD."

THE CONTRADICTION AT THE HEART OF IT
He "talked of the GREATNESS OF MAHATMA GANDHI, said he was INSPIRED BY THE NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT, and persuaded people to WEAR KHADI AND GIVE UP DRINKING.

BUT AT THE SAME TIME HE ASSERTED THAT INDIA COULD BE LIBERATED ONLY BY THE USE OF FORCE, NOT NON-VIOLENCE."

"The Gudum rebels ATTACKED POLICE STATIONS, attempted to KILL BRITISH OFFICIALS and carried on GUERRILLA WARFARE for achieving swaraj."

"Raju was CAPTURED AND EXECUTED IN 1924, and over time BECAME A FOLK HERO."

🔗 ★★★★★ **Raju is the perfect illustration of the chapter's thesis, and he links straight back to Class 9 Ch.4.** He adopted Gandhi's **cultural programme** (khadi, temperance) and Gandhi's **name**, while rejecting Gandhi's **method** outright. **The movement was one; the meanings were many.** And note the grievance itself is the **Forest Acts** — the Gudum hill people are the same category as Bastar's rebels and the Baigas. **For forest communities, swaraj meant the forest back.**

🌱 2.3 Swaraj in the plantations ★★★★★

Element	Detail
★★ What freedom meant here	"For plantation workers in ASSAM , freedom meant the right to MOVE FREELY IN AND OUT of the confined space in which they were enclosed , and it meant RETAINING A LINK WITH THE VILLAGE FROM WHICH THEY HAD COME "
★★★ The law	"Under the INLAND EMIGRATION ACT OF 1859 , plantation workers were not permitted to leave the tea gardens without permission , and in fact they were RARELY GIVEN such permission "
★★ What they did	"When they heard of the Non-Cooperation Movement, thousands of workers DEFIED the authorities, LEFT the plantations and HEADED HOME . They believed that ★ GANDHI RAJ WAS COMING AND EVERYONE WOULD BE GIVEN LAND IN THEIR OWN VILLAGES "
★★ What happened	*"They, however, NEVER REACHED THEIR DESTINATION . Stranded on the way by a RAILWAY AND STEAMER STRIKE , they were CAUGHT BY THE POLICE and BRUTALLY BEATEN UP ."*

🎯 ★★★★★ The cruelty of the detail is that the thing that stranded them was another arm of the same movement — a railway and steamer strike. **Two groups acting for swaraj, and one destroyed the other's attempt.** That is what an uncoordinated mass movement looks like from inside, and it is worth one sentence in any answer about the difficulties of forging unity.

📖 The paragraph that ties the section together — ★★★★★ learn it

*"The visions of these movements were **NOT DEFINED BY THE CONGRESS PROGRAMME**. They interpreted the term swaraj in their own ways, imagining it to be a time when **ALL SUFFERING AND ALL TROUBLES WOULD BE OVER**. ★★ **YET**, when the tribals chanted Gandhiji's name and raised slogans demanding '**SWATANTRA BHARAT**', **THEY WERE ALSO EMOTIONALLY RELATING TO AN ALL-INDIA AGITATION**. When they acted in the name of Mahatma Gandhi, or linked their movement to that of the Congress, **THEY WERE IDENTIFYING WITH A MOVEMENT WHICH WENT BEYOND THE LIMITS OF THEIR IMMEDIATE LOCALITY**."*

★★★★★ This is the resolution of the chapter's central tension, and the best answers reproduce its balance. The groups **misunderstood** the programme — and the misunderstanding was itself the nation-building. A Gudum hill man fighting for his forest **in the name of an all-India leader** has begun to think of himself as part of India. ★ **Local grievance plus a national vocabulary is how a nation actually forms** — not by everyone agreeing on the goal, but by everyone learning to phrase their own goal in a shared language. (*Set this beside Renan in Ch.1: not common language or race, but "a common will in the present" — however differently each party imagines what it wills.*)

3 Towards Civil Disobedience

● The withdrawal, February 1922

"In February 1922, Mahatma Gandhi decided to **withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement**. He felt the movement was **turning violent in many places** and **satyagrahis needed to be PROPERLY TRAINED before they would be ready for mass struggles**." The trigger — Chauri Chaura: "At Chauri Chaura in Gorakhpur, a peaceful demonstration in a bazaar turned into a violent clash with the police. Hearing of the incident, Mahatma Gandhi **called a halt** to the Non-Cooperation Movement."

🏠 The interlude — the Swaraj Party and the radicals

Group	Position
★ ★ C.R. DAS and MOTILAL NEHRU — the SWARAJ PARTY within the Congress	"some leaders were by now tired of mass struggles and wanted to participate in elections to the provincial councils set up by the Government of India Act of 1919 . They felt it was important to oppose British policies WITHIN the councils, argue for reform and also DEMONSTRATE THAT THESE COUNCILS WERE NOT TRULY DEMOCRATIC "
★ ★ JAWAHARLAL NEHRU and SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE	"younger leaders... pressed for MORE RADICAL MASS AGITATION and for FULL INDEPENDENCE "

📉 The two factors that shaped the late 1920s

FACTOR 1 -- THE WORLDWIDE ECONOMIC DEPRESSION

"AGRICULTURAL PRICES BEGAN TO FALL FROM 1926 AND COLLAPSED AFTER 1930. As the demand for agricultural goods fell and EXPORTS DECLINED, peasants found it DIFFICULT TO SELL THEIR HARVESTS AND PAY THEIR REVENUE. BY 1930, THE COUNTRYSIDE WAS IN TURMOIL."

FACTOR 2 -- THE SIMON COMMISSION

"the new TORY government in Britain constituted a STATUTORY COMMISSION under SIR JOHN SIMON", to "look into the functioning of the CONSTITUTIONAL SYSTEM in India and suggest changes."

"THE PROBLEM WAS THAT THE COMMISSION DID NOT HAVE A SINGLE INDIAN MEMBER. THEY WERE ALL BRITISH."

1928 -- greeted with the slogan "GO BACK SIMON".

"ALL PARTIES, INCLUDING THE CONGRESS AND THE MUSLIM LEAGUE, participated in the demonstrations."

LALA LAJPAT RAI "was assaulted by the British police during a peaceful demonstration against the Simon Commission. He **SUCCUMBED TO INJURIES**."

The failed offer and the radical turn:

- ★ **October 1929** — Viceroy **Lord Irwin** announced "a **VAGUE OFFER of 'DOMINION STATUS' for India in an UNSPECIFIED FUTURE**, and a **Round Table Conference** to discuss a future constitution." This did not satisfy the Congress leaders.
- "The **radicals, led by Nehru and Bose**, became more assertive. The **liberals and moderates**, who were proposing a constitutional system **within the framework of British dominion, gradually lost their influence**."
- ★ ★ ★ **December 1929** — "under the presidency of **Jawaharlal Nehru**, the **LAHORE CONGRESS** formalised the demand of '**PURNA SWARAJ' or FULL INDEPENDENCE** for India. It was declared that ★ ★ **26 JANUARY 1930 would be celebrated as INDEPENDENCE DAY**, when people were to take a pledge to struggle for complete independence."

- ⚠️ **But:** *"the celebrations attracted VERY LITTLE ATTENTION. So Mahatma Gandhi had to find a way to relate this ABSTRACT IDEA OF FREEDOM to more CONCRETE ISSUES OF EVERYDAY LIFE."*

Source C — the Independence Day Pledge, 26 January 1930: *"We believe that it is the inalienable right of the Indian people, as of any other people, to have freedom and to enjoy the fruits of their toil and have the necessities of life... We believe also that if any government deprives a people of these rights and oppresses them, THE PEOPLE HAVE A FURTHER RIGHT TO ALTER IT OR TO ABOLISH IT. The British Government in India has not only deprived the Indian people of their freedom but has based itself on the EXPLOITATION OF THE MASSES, and has RUINED INDIA ECONOMICALLY, POLITICALLY, CULTURALLY, AND SPIRITUALLY. We believe, therefore, that India must sever the British connection and attain PURNA SWARAJ."*

🎯 ★★☆☆ Two things to notice. First, 26 January was chosen as Independence Day in 1930 — which is why it became Republic Day in 1950. Second, and more instructive: the pledge failed to move people. *"The celebrations attracted very little attention."* A correctly worded demand for complete independence produced almost nothing. What follows is Gandhi's answer to that failure — and it is the best lesson in political communication in the whole book.

📁 3.1 The Salt March — ★★☆☆★ why salt?

31 JANUARY 1930 -- Gandhi's letter to Viceroy IRWIN, stating ELEVEN DEMANDS.

"Some of these were of GENERAL INTEREST; others were SPECIFIC DEMANDS OF DIFFERENT CLASSES, from INDUSTRIALISTS to PEASANTS. THE IDEA WAS TO MAKE THE DEMANDS WIDE-RANGING, SO THAT ALL CLASSES WITHIN INDIAN SOCIETY COULD IDENTIFY WITH THEM AND EVERYONE COULD BE BROUGHT TOGETHER IN A UNITED CAMPAIGN."

"The MOST STIRRING of all was the demand to ABOLISH THE SALT TAX. SALT WAS SOMETHING CONSUMED BY THE RICH AND THE POOR ALIKE, and it was ONE OF THE MOST ESSENTIAL ITEMS OF FOOD. The TAX on salt and the GOVERNMENT MONOPOLY over its production, Mahatma Gandhi declared, REVEALED THE MOST OPPRESSIVE FACE OF BRITISH RULE."

THE ULTIMATUM: if the demands were not fulfilled by 11 MARCH, the Congress would launch civil disobedience. "IRWIN WAS UNWILLING TO NEGOTIATE."

THE MARCH

- accompanied by 78 OF HIS TRUSTED VOLUNTEERS
- OVER 240 MILES, from the SABARMATI ashram to the Gujarati coastal town of DANDI
- 24 DAYS, about 10 MILES A DAY
- "Thousands came to hear Mahatma Gandhi wherever he stopped, and HE TOLD THEM WHAT HE MEANT BY SWARAJ and urged them to PEACEFULLY DEFY the British"

6 APRIL -- he reached DANDI and "CEREMONIALLY VIOLATED THE LAW, MANUFACTURING SALT BY BOILING SEA WATER."

★★★★★ "Discuss the Salt March to make clear why it was an effective symbol of resistance" is NCERT's own question and a near-certain Mains prompt. The answer has five parts: (i) **UNIVERSALITY** — salt is "consumed by the rich and the poor alike", so a grievance about it belongs to everyone; nothing else in the eleven demands could unite an industrialist and a landless labourer. (ii) **NECESSITY** — it is "one of the most essential items of food", so taxing it is taxing survival itself. **A tax on salt cannot be avoided by going without.** (iii) **IT MADE THE ABSTRACT CONCRETE** — *Purna Swaraj* had attracted "very little attention"; **a fistful of salt made independence something you could hold.** (iv) **THE ACT WAS AVAILABLE TO ANYONE** — you did not need a party card, literacy or courage under fire. **Anyone near the coast could break this law, and everyone else could buy the salt.** (v) **IT PUT THE STATE IN AN IMPOSSIBLE POSITION** — arresting people for boiling seawater made the empire look **absurd and petty**, and doing nothing made it look **powerless**. ★ **The best symbol is one where the opponent's every response damages him.** 🌀 And note the 24-day walk was not transport — **it was the campaign.** Speaking to thousands at every halt, Gandhi spent three and a half weeks **explaining what swaraj meant**, which is exactly what the 26 January pledge had failed to do.

✂ How Civil Disobedience differed from Non-Cooperation — ★★★★★

"People were now asked **not only to REFUSE COOPERATION with the British, as they had done in 1921-22, BUT ALSO TO BREAK COLONIAL LAWS.**"

	NON-COOPERATION (1921-22)	CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE (1930-34)
The act	Withdraw — surrender titles, boycott schools, courts, councils, foreign goods	★ Break the law — manufacture salt, refuse taxes, violate forest laws
Legality	Refusing to participate was lawful	Deliberately illegal , inviting arrest
Trigger	Rowlatt Act + Jallianwala Bagh + Khilafat	Salt tax , after the eleven demands were refused
Muslim participation	Substantial , through Khilafat	★ Much reduced — "some Muslim political organisations were lukewarm"
Scale of repression	Severe	★ about 100,000 arrested
Ended by	Chauri Chaura , Feb 1922	Gandhi-Irwin Pact , 5 March 1931; relaunched 1932; lost momentum by 1934

What the movement looked like on the ground: "Thousands in different parts of the country **broke the salt law, manufactured salt and demonstrated in front of government salt factories.** As the movement spread, **foreign cloth was boycotted, and liquor shops were picketed.** **Peasants refused to pay REVENUE and CHAUKIDARI TAXES, village officials RESIGNED, and** ★ **in many places FOREST PEOPLE VIOLATED FOREST LAWS — going into Reserved Forests to collect wood and graze cattle.**"

The repression:

- ★ **April 1930** — when **Abdul Ghaffar Khan**, "a devout disciple of Mahatma Gandhi", was arrested,
*"angry crowds demonstrated in the streets of **PESHAWAR**, facing **armoured cars and police firing.** **Many were killed.**"*
- ★ **A month later**, when **Gandhi himself was arrested**, "industrial workers in **SHOLAPUR** attacked **police posts, municipal buildings, lawcourts and railway stations — all structures that symbolised British rule.**"
- ★★ "A frightened government responded with a policy of **brutal repression.** Peaceful satyagrahis were attacked, **women and children were beaten, and about 100,000 people were arrested.**"

The pact and the aftermath:

Date	Event
★ ★ 5 March 1931	The GANDHI-IRWIN PACT — Gandhi "consented to participate in a Round Table Conference (the Congress had boycotted the first) in London and the government agreed to release the political prisoners "
★ December 1931	Gandhi went to London for the conference, "but the negotiations broke down and he returned disappointed "
⚠ Back in India	"the government had begun a new cycle of repression . Ghaffar Khan and Jawaharlal Nehru were both in jail, the Congress had been declared ILLEGAL , and a series of measures had been imposed to prevent meetings, demonstrations and boycotts "
★ 1932	"With great apprehension, Mahatma Gandhi relaunched the Civil Disobedience Movement. For over a year, the movement continued, but by 1934 it lost its momentum "

Box 1 — the revolutionary alternative. "Many nationalists thought that the struggle against the British could not be won through non-violence." In 1928 the ★ **HINDUSTAN SOCIALIST REPUBLICAN ARMY (HSRA)** was founded at **Ferozeshah Kotla ground, Delhi**; leaders included ★ **Bhagat Singh, Jatin Das and Ajoy Ghosh**. ★ **April 1929** — Bhagat Singh and Batukeswar Dutta threw a bomb in the **Legislative Assembly**; the same year came **an attempt to blow up the train Lord Irwin was travelling in**. ★ ★ **Bhagat Singh was 23 when he was tried and executed**. In his own words at the trial — and note he explicitly rejects the caricature: "he did not wish to glorify '**the cult of the bomb and pistol**' but wanted **a revolution in society**" — *"**Revolution is the inalienable right of mankind. Freedom is the imprescriptible birthright of all. THE LABOURER IS THE REAL SUSTAINER OF SOCIETY... To the altar of this revolution we have brought our youth as incense, for no sacrifice is too great for so magnificent a cause. We are content. We await the advent of revolution. INQUILAB ZINDABAD!**"* 🌀 ★ ★ ★ **Do not reduce Bhagat Singh to a bomb-thrower — he took care not to be so reduced.** "*The labourer is the real sustainer of society*" is a **socialist** claim about **what** independence is for, not merely a militant claim about how to get it. **His disagreement with Gandhi was about method AND about the content of freedom.**

👥 3.2 How participants saw the movement — ★★★★★ THE TABLE TO MEMORISE

Group	Why they joined	What swaraj meant	Where it broke down
★★★★ RICH PEASANTS — Patidars of Gujarat, Jats of UP	"Being producers of COMMERCIAL CROPS , they were very hard hit by the trade depression and falling prices . As their cash income disappeared , they found it impossible to pay the government's revenue demand "	★★ "For them the fight for swaraj was A STRUGGLE AGAINST HIGH REVENUES "	★★ "deeply disappointed when the movement was called off in 1931 WITHOUT THE REVENUE RATES BEING REVISED . So when the movement was restarted in 1932, many of them REFUSED TO PARTICIPATE "
★★★★ POOR PEASANTS / small tenants	"cultivating land they had RENTED from landlords . As the Depression continued and cash incomes dwindled, they found it difficult to pay their RENT "	★★ "They wanted THE UNPAID RENT TO BE REMITTED " — and "joined a variety of radical movements, often led by SOCIALISTS AND COMMUNISTS "	★★★★ "Apprehensive of raising issues that might UPSET THE RICH PEASANTS AND LANDLORDS , the Congress was UNWILLING TO SUPPORT 'NO RENT' CAMPAIGNS in most places. So the relationship between the poor peasants and the Congress REMAINED UNCERTAIN "
★★★★ BUSINESS CLASSES	"During the First World War, Indian merchants and industrialists had made huge profits and become powerful... they now reacted against colonial policies that restricted business activities . They wanted protection against imports and a rupee-sterling exchange ratio that would discourage imports " — organised as ★ the Indian Industrial and Commercial Congress (1920) and ★★ FICCI (1927), led by ★ Purshottamdas Thakurdas and G.D. Birla. They gave financial assistance and refused to buy or sell imported goods	★★ "Most businessmen came to see swaraj as a time when COLONIAL RESTRICTIONS ON BUSINESS WOULD NO LONGER EXIST and TRADE AND INDUSTRY WOULD FLOURISH WITHOUT CONSTRAINTS "	★★ "after the failure of the Round Table Conference... apprehensive of the spread of MILITANT ACTIVITIES , worried about prolonged disruption of business , as well as of the growing influence of SOCIALISM amongst the younger members of the Congress "
★★★★ INDUSTRIAL WORKERS	" did NOT participate in large numbers, except in the NAGPUR region . ★★ As the industrialists came closer to the Congress, WORKERS STAYED ALOOF "	Selective adoption — "some of the ideas of the Gandhian programme, like boycott of foreign goods , as part of their own movements against LOW WAGES and POOR WORKING CONDITIONS ". ★ Strikes by railway workers in 1930 and dockworkers in 1932; in 1930 thousands of workers in Chotanagpur tin mines wore Gandhi caps	★★★★ " the Congress was RELUCTANT to include workers' demands as part of its programme of struggle. It felt that this would ALIENATE INDUSTRIALISTS and DIVIDE THE ANTI-IMPERIAL FORCES "
★★★★ WOMEN	"another important feature... was the LARGE-SCALE PARTICIPATION OF WOMEN . During the salt march, thousands of women came out of their homes to listen to him . They participated in protest marches, manufactured salt, and picketed foreign cloth and liquor shops . Many went to jail " — ★ "In urban areas these women were from high-caste	★ "Moved by Gandhiji's call, they began to see SERVICE TO THE NATION as a SACRED DUTY of women "	★★★★★ "Yet this increased public role did NOT necessarily mean any RADICAL CHANGE in the way the position of women was visualised. Gandhiji was convinced that it was the duty of women to LOOK AFTER HOME AND HEARTH, BE GOOD MOTHERS AND GOOD WIVES . And for a long time the Congress was RELUCTANT TO ALLOW WOMEN TO HOLD ANY

Group	Why they joined	What swaraj meant	Where it broke down
	<i>families; in rural areas from rich peasant households"</i>		POSITION OF AUTHORITY within the organisation. IT WAS KEEN ONLY ON THEIR SYMBOLIC PRESENCE." *

🎯 ★★★★★ Read down the last column and you have the answer to almost any Mains question on this chapter. The Congress could not simultaneously satisfy **rich peasants** (who wanted revenue cut) and **poor tenants** (who wanted rent remitted, from those same rich peasants); nor **industrialists** (who funded it) and **workers** (who struck against those industrialists). ★ **The movement's breadth was purchased by leaving the sharpest internal conflicts unaddressed** — which is why *"the high points of Congress activity and nationalist unity were followed by phases of disunity."* **A national movement against a foreign ruler can postpone the question of who rules whom internally; it cannot answer it.** ⚠️ **And be precise about women:** mass participation, **real courage, jail** — but drawn from **high-caste and rich-peasant households**, framed as **sacred duty rather than rights**, with **no positions of authority** and *"symbolic presence"* only. **Say both halves.** (Compare the Class 9 supplement: Gandhi's khadi and the woman who could not afford it.)

⚖️ 3.3 The limits of Civil Disobedience

🔥 The dalits — ★★★★★ the most important section in the chapter for GS1 and Polity

THE GROUP

"the nation's 'untouchables', who FROM AROUND THE 1930s had begun to CALL THEMSELVES DALIT OR OPPRESSED."

"For long the Congress had IGNORED THE DALITS, FOR FEAR OF OFFENDING THE SANATANIS, THE CONSERVATIVE HIGH-CASTE HINDUS."

GANDHI'S POSITION

"swaraj would NOT COME FOR A HUNDRED YEARS IF UNTOUCHABILITY WAS NOT ELIMINATED."

- called them HARIJAN, "the children of God"
- "organised SATYAGRAHA to secure them ENTRY INTO TEMPLES, and ACCESS TO PUBLIC WELLS, TANKS, ROADS AND SCHOOLS"
- "He himself CLEANED TOILETS to dignify the work of the BHANGI (the sweepers)"
- "persuaded UPPER CASTES to CHANGE THEIR HEART and give up 'THE SIN OF UNTOUCHABILITY'"

THE DALIT POSITION -- A DIFFERENT DIAGNOSIS ENTIRELY
 "But many dalit leaders were keen on A DIFFERENT POLITICAL SOLUTION to the problems of the community. They began ORGANISING THEMSELVES, demanding:

- RESERVED SEATS in educational institutions
 - a SEPARATE ELECTORATE that would choose dalit members for legislative councils
- POLITICAL EMPOWERMENT, THEY BELIEVED, WOULD RESOLVE THE PROBLEMS OF THEIR SOCIAL DISABILITIES."

RESULT: "Dalit participation in the Civil Disobedience Movement was therefore LIMITED, particularly in the MAHARASHTRA AND NAGPUR region where their organisation was quite strong."

The clash and the Pact:

Step	Detail
★ ★ 1930	Dr B.R. Ambedkar organised the dalits into the DEPRESSED CLASSES ASSOCIATION
★ ★ Second Round Table Conference	Ambedkar "clashed with Mahatma Gandhi... by demanding SEPARATE ELECTORATES for dalits "
★ ★ ★ Gandhi's response	"When the British government conceded Ambedkar's demand , Gandhiji began a FAST UNTO DEATH . He believed that separate electorates for dalits would SLOW DOWN THE PROCESS OF THEIR INTEGRATION INTO SOCIETY "
★ ★ ★ ★ THE POONA PACT, September 1932	"Ambedkar ultimately accepted Gandhiji's position ... It gave the Depressed Classes (later to be known as the Scheduled Castes) RESERVED SEATS in provincial and central legislative councils, BUT THEY WERE TO BE VOTED IN BY THE GENERAL ELECTORATE "
⚠ After	"The dalit movement, however, continued to be apprehensive of the Congress-led national movement "

★ ★ ★ ★ ★ This is the single most valuable passage in the chapter, and it must be written with real care — it is a live question in Indian politics and a lazy answer will be a bad one.

The disagreement was not about whether untouchability was evil. Both agreed it was. It was about what kind of problem it is, and therefore what fixes it.

- **Gandhi diagnosed a MORAL problem** — a "sin" in the hearts of caste Hindus, to be cured by **change of heart**, temple entry and the dignifying of degraded work. On that diagnosis, a **separate electorate is a disaster**: it makes the division permanent and **removes the pressure on caste Hindus to reform**, so it would "slow down the process of their integration."
- **Ambedkar diagnosed a POLITICAL problem** — a structure of power, not a defect of sentiment. On that diagnosis, ★ "political empowerment would resolve the problems of their social disabilities", and a **separate electorate is essential**, because representatives chosen by a general electorate will owe their seats to the majority that oppresses them and will therefore never truly represent them.

⚠ **And be honest about the fast.** Gandhi used a fast unto death against a concession that had already been granted to the weakest group in Indian society, and Ambedkar "ultimately accepted" — under the certain knowledge that Gandhi's death would be blamed on dalits and bring retaliation. **The outcome was reserved seats with a general electorate: Ambedkar got the numbers and lost the independence.** That is why "the dalit movement continued to be apprehensive."

🔗 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ The Polity link is direct and worth stating: the Poona Pact is the origin of SC reservation of seats in Indian legislatures — reserved constituencies where **all** voters vote, exactly as agreed in 1932, and carried into **Articles 330 and 332** of the Constitution. **The compromise of 1932 is still the design of the Lok Sabha today.**

THE ALIENATION

"After the DECLINE OF THE NON-COOPERATION-KHILAFAT MOVEMENT, a large section of Muslims FELT ALIENATED FROM THE CONGRESS."

"From the MID-1920s the Congress came to be more visibly associated with OPENLY HINDU RELIGIOUS NATIONALIST GROUPS LIKE THE HINDU MAHASABHA."

"As relations worsened, EACH COMMUNITY ORGANISED RELIGIOUS PROCESSIONS WITH MILITANT FERVOUR, provoking COMMUNAL CLASHES AND RIOTS in various cities. EVERY RIOT DEEPENED THE DISTANCE between the two communities."

THE NEAR-MISS OF 1927-28

MUHAMMAD ALI JINNAH "was WILLING TO GIVE UP THE DEMAND FOR SEPARATE ELECTORATES, IF Muslims were assured:
- RESERVED SEATS in the Central Assembly, and
- REPRESENTATION IN PROPORTION TO POPULATION in the Muslim-dominated provinces (BENGAL and PUNJAB)"

"all hope of resolving the issue at the ALL PARTIES CONFERENCE IN 1928 DISAPPEARED when M.R. JAYAKAR OF THE HINDU MAHASABHA STRONGLY OPPOSED EFFORTS AT COMPROMISE."

"When the Civil Disobedience Movement started there was thus AN ATMOSPHERE OF SUSPICION AND DISTRUST between communities. ALIENATED from the Congress, large sections of Muslims COULD NOT RESPOND to the call for a united struggle."

"Many Muslim leaders and intellectuals expressed CONCERN ABOUT THE STATUS OF MUSLIMS AS A MINORITY within India. THEY FEARED THAT THE CULTURE AND IDENTITY OF MINORITIES WOULD BE SUBMERGED UNDER THE DOMINATION OF A HINDU MAJORITY."

★★★★★ **The 1928 near-miss is the detail that matters most, and it is routinely left out of exam answers. Jinnah offered to give up separate electorates** in exchange for guaranteed proportional representation — an offer that, accepted, would have removed the central constitutional grievance. **It failed because the Hindu Mahasabha refused compromise.** ★ **Partition was not inevitable in 1928**, and saying so — with this evidence — is far stronger history than treating communal division as a permanent condition.

Source D — Sir Muhammad Iqbal, as president of the Muslim League, **1930**. NCERT notes his statement *"is supposed to have provided the intellectual justification for the Pakistan demand"*: *"if the principle that the Indian Muslim is entitled to full and free development on the lines of his own culture and tradition in his own Indian home-lands is recognised as the basis of a permanent communal settlement, he will be ready to STAKE HIS ALL FOR THE FREEDOM OF INDIA. The principle that each group is entitled to free development on its own lines is not inspired by any feeling of narrow communalism... A community which is inspired by feelings of ill-will towards other communities is LOW AND IGNOBLE. I entertain the highest respect for the customs, laws, religions and social institutions of other communities. Nay, it is my duty according to the teachings of the Quran, even to DEFEND THEIR PLACES OF WORSHIP, if need be. Yet I love the communal group... which has formed me what I am... ★ Communalism in its HIGHER ASPECT, then, is INDISPENSABLE to the formation of a HARMONIOUS WHOLE in a country like India. THE UNITS OF INDIAN SOCIETY ARE NOT TERRITORIAL AS IN EUROPEAN COUNTRIES... The principle of European democracy CANNOT BE APPLIED TO INDIA WITHOUT RECOGNISING THE FACT OF COMMUNAL GROUPS.... The Hindu thinks that separate electorates are contrary to the spirit of true nationalism, because he understands the word 'nation' to mean A KIND OF UNIVERSAL AMALGAMATION IN WHICH NO COMMUNAL ENTITY OUGHT TO RETAIN ITS PRIVATE INDIVIDUALITY. Such a state of things, however, does not exist. INDIA IS A LAND OF RACIAL AND RELIGIOUS VARIETY. Add to this the general economic inferiority of the Muslims, their enormous debt, especially in the Punjab, and their insufficient majorities in some of the provinces... and you will begin to see clearly the meaning of our anxiety to retain separate electorates."**

🎯 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ NCERT asks whether you agree with Iqbal's idea of communalism — so understand the argument before judging it. Iqbal distinguishes communalism as ill-will (which he calls *"low and ignoble"* and disavows) from communalism as the recognition that Indian society's units are groups, not territories. His claim is that European-style majoritarian democracy, applied to a society organised by community rather than region, simply installs a permanent majority — so safeguards are not a betrayal of nationalism but a precondition for it. ★ ★ Notice the structural identity with Ambedkar's argument in the previous section. Both say: *a minority that must be elected by a general electorate will be represented by people the majority finds acceptable. Two very different leaders reached the same conclusion about the same electoral mechanism — which is the most interesting thing on this page, and almost nobody writes it.* ⚠️ Note too the difference in outcome: **Ambedkar's demand was traded away in the Poona Pact; Iqbal's line of argument ran on toward 1940.**

4 The Sense of Collective Belonging ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

*"Nationalism spreads when people begin to believe that they are all part of the same nation, when they discover some unity that binds them together... This sense of collective belonging came partly through the experience of UNITED STRUGGLES. But there were also a variety of CULTURAL PROCESSES through which nationalism captured people's imagination. ★ HISTORY and FICTION, FOLKLORE and SONGS, POPULAR PRINTS and SYMBOLS, all played a part."**

Bharat Mata

Step	Detail
★★ Origin	"The image was first created by BANKIM CHANDRA CHATTOPADHYAY . In the 1870s he wrote ' VANDE MATARAM ' as a hymn to the motherland. Later it was included in his novel ANANDAMATH and widely sung during the SWADESHI movement in Bengal "
★★ The painting	"Moved by the Swadeshi movement, ABANINDRANATH TAGORE painted his famous image of Bharat Mata" — portrayed as an ASCETIC figure ; calm, composed, divine and spiritual, "shown as dispensing learning, food and clothing . The mala in one hand emphasises her ascetic quality "
★★ And then it multiplied	"In subsequent years, the image acquired many different forms , as it circulated in POPULAR PRINTS , and was painted by different artists " — one later version shows her "with a TRISHUL , standing beside a LION and an ELEPHANT — both symbols of power and authority "
★★ The demand it made	*"DEVOTION TO THIS MOTHER FIGURE CAME TO BE SEEN AS EVIDENCE OF ONE'S NATIONALISM." *

 ★★★★★ NCERT explicitly asks you to compare Bharat Mata with Germania (Ch.1). Do it properly:

	GERMANIA	BHARAT MATA
Form	Female allegory, crown of oak leaves , breastplate, sword	Female allegory, ascetic , mala, dispensing learning, food and clothing
Register	Civic and martial — a <i>people's</i> nation	★ Religious and devotional — " <i>devotion... came to be seen as evidence of one's nationalism</i> "
Source of authority	Broken chains = freedom won	Divinity — she is worshipped, not merely saluted
The problem	Could be shown fallen (Hübner, 1850) or guarding the Rhine (1860) — a political argument	★★ Drawn from HINDU iconography — trishul, lion, the goddess form — so " when the images celebrated were drawn from Hindu iconography, then people of other communities FELT LEFT OUT "

★★ That last cell is the point, and it connects §4 straight back to §3.3. The very symbols that unified one community **signalled exclusion to another**. A nation made of religious imagery **cannot be a nation of all its people** — and the Muslim alienation described earlier is not a separate story from this one.

🎵 Folklore, flags, history

Instrument	Detail
★★ Folklore revival	"nationalists began recording folk tales sung by bards and toured villages to gather folk songs and legends . These tales, they believed, gave a true picture of traditional culture that had been CORRUPTED AND DAMAGED BY OUTSIDE FORCES . It was essential to preserve this folk tradition in order to DISCOVER ONE'S NATIONAL IDENTITY and RESTORE A SENSE OF PRIDE in one's past "
★ In Bengal	" RABINDRANATH TAGORE himself began collecting BALLADS, NURSERY RHYMES and MYTHS , and led the movement for folk revival "
★★ In Madras	" NATESA SASTRI published a massive FOUR-VOLUME collection of Tamil folk tales, The Folklore of Southern India . He believed that folklore was NATIONAL LITERATURE ; it was 'the most trustworthy manifestation of people's real thoughts and characteristics' "
★★ The Swadeshi flag	"During the Swadeshi movement in Bengal, a tricolour flag (RED, GREEN and YELLOW) was designed. It had EIGHT LOTUSES representing eight provinces of British India, and a CRESCENT MOON, representing Hindus and Muslims "
★★★ The Swaraj flag, 1921	"By 1921, Gandhiji had designed the SWARAJ FLAG . It was again a tricolour (RED, GREEN and WHITE) and had a SPINNING WHEEL in the centre, representing the Gandhian ideal of SELF-HELP . Carrying the flag, holding it aloft, during marches became A SYMBOL OF DEFIANCE "
★★★ Reinterpreting history	"The British saw Indians as backward and primitive, incapable of governing themselves . In response, Indians began looking into the past to discover India's GREAT ACHIEVEMENTS — the glorious developments in ancient times when art and architecture, science and mathematics, religion and culture, law and philosophy, crafts and trade had flourished . This glorious time, in their view, was followed by A HISTORY OF DECLINE, when India was colonised "

🔗 ★★★ Every one of these has a European twin from Ch.1 — the folklore collection is **Herder and the Grimms**, the flag is **the black-red-gold tricolour**, the allegory is **Germania**, and the glorious-past-then-decline narrative is **exactly how the Balkan nationalities argued**. ★ But NCERT immediately adds the Indian complication, and it is the one Europe did not face:

★★★★★ **"These efforts to unify people were NOT WITHOUT PROBLEMS. When the past being GLORIFIED WAS HINDU, when the images celebrated were DRAWN FROM HINDU ICONOGRAPHY, THEN PEOPLE OF OTHER COMMUNITIES FELT LEFT OUT."***

Source E — Tarinicharan Chattopadhyay, *Bharatbarsher Itihas*, 1858, showing the decline narrative in its own words: **"In earlier times, foreign travellers in India MARVELLED at the courage, truthfulness and modesty of the people of the ARYA VAMSA; now they remark mainly on THE ABSENCE OF THOSE QUALITIES**. In those days **Hindus would set out on conquest and hoist their flags in Tartar, China and other countries; now a few soldiers from a tiny island far away are lording it over the land of India.**"* ⚠️ 🎯 **Read the source critically, which is what NCERT wants**. The glorious past invoked is explicitly **"the Arya vamsa"** and **"Hindus"**; the intervening centuries — including Muslim rule — sit inside the "decline". ★ **A history written to restore pride in one community's past was, by construction, a history in which another community's past was the problem**. (This is James Mill's periodisation from **Class 8 Ch.1**, inverted but structurally intact — the same three-part Hindu/Muslim/British frame, with the value judgements reversed.)

❏ Conclusion and Quit India

★★★★★ *"The Congress under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi tried to **channel people's grievances into organised movements** for independence... **But diverse groups and classes participated with VARIED ASPIRATIONS AND EXPECTATIONS.** As their grievances were wide-ranging, **FREEDOM FROM COLONIAL RULE ALSO MEANT DIFFERENT THINGS TO DIFFERENT PEOPLE.** ★★ The Congress continuously attempted to resolve differences, and ensure that **THE DEMANDS OF ONE GROUP DID NOT ALIENATE ANOTHER. THIS IS PRECISELY WHY THE UNITY WITHIN THE MOVEMENT OFTEN BROKE DOWN.** The high points of Congress activity and nationalist unity were followed by phases of disunity and inner conflict between groups. In other words, ★★★★★ **what was emerging was A NATION WITH MANY VOICES WANTING FREEDOM FROM COLONIAL RULE.**"*

IN Quit India, 1942

Element	Detail
The trigger	"The failure of the CRIPPS MISSION and the effects of World War II created widespread discontentment"
★ 14 July 1942	The Congress Working Committee , meeting at WARDHA , passed the historic ' Quit India ' resolution demanding the immediate transfer of power to Indians
★★ 8 August 1942, Bombay	The All India Congress Committee endorsed the resolution, calling for a non-violent mass struggle on the widest possible scale. ★★ "It was on this occasion that Gandhiji delivered the famous ' DO OR DIE ' speech"
★★ The scale	"The call almost brought the state machinery to a standstill in large parts of the country as people voluntarily threw themselves into the thick of the movement " — hartals, demonstrations and processions accompanied by national songs and slogans
★★ Who	"truly a mass movement which brought into its ambit thousands of ordinary people — students, workers and peasants "; with leaders ★ Jayprakash Narayan, Aruna Asaf Ali and Ram Manohar Lohia , and women including ★ Matangini Hazra (Bengal), Kanaklata Barua (Assam) and Rama Devi (Odisha)
★ The suppression	"The British responded with much force, yet it took more than a year to suppress the movement "

 Prelims traps

Trap	The truth
"Gandhi returned to India in 1919"	★ January 1915
"Champaran 1918, Kheda 1917"	★★ Champaran 1917 (plantation system); Ahmedabad 1918 (cotton mill workers); Kheda 1918 (crop failure and plague — revenue relief)
"The Rowlatt Act allowed detention for six months"	★★ Two years without trial ; passed " <i>despite the united opposition of the Indian members</i> "
"Jallianwala Bagh was 6 April 1919"	★★ 6 April was the hartal ; 10 April the Amritsar firing; ★ 13 April Jallianwala Bagh, during the Baisakhi fair
"The Khilafat Committee was formed in Delhi in 1920"	★★ Bombay, March 1919 . Non-Cooperation was adopted at the Calcutta session, September 1920 , and finalised at ★ Nagpur, December 1920
"Hind Swaraj was published in 1919"	★ 1909
"All provinces boycotted the council elections"	★★ Except MADRAS , where the Justice Party (non-Brahmans) entered the councils
"Foreign cloth imports fell from Rs 102 crore to Rs 57 crore between 1920 and 1930"	★★ Between 1921 and 1922 — it halved
"Baba Ramchandra led the Gudem rebellion"	★★ Baba Ramchandra = AWADH (a sanyasi, formerly an indentured labourer in Fiji); Alluri Sitaram Raju = GUDEM hills, Andhra , executed 1924
"The Oudh Kisan Sabha was headed by Gandhi"	★ Jawaharlal Nehru, Baba Ramchandra and others, October 1920 ; over 300 branches within a month
"Plantation workers were freed by the Inland Emigration Act"	★★ The Act of 1859 FORBADE them to leave the tea gardens without permission, " <i>rarely given</i> "
"Non-Cooperation was withdrawn after Jallianwala Bagh"	★★ Withdrawn February 1922 after CHAURI CHAURA (Gorakhpur)
"The Swaraj Party was founded by Nehru and Bose"	★★ C.R. Das and Motilal Nehru ; Nehru and Bose pressed the opposite way — radical mass agitation and full independence
"The Simon Commission had two Indian members"	★★ Not a single Indian member . Arrived 1928 , met with " Go back Simon "; Lala Lajpat Rai died of injuries from a police assault during a demonstration against it
"Purna Swaraj was adopted at Karachi in 1931"	★★★ Lahore Congress, December 1929 , under Nehru's presidency ; 26 January 1930 declared Independence Day
"Gandhi sent Irwin nine demands"	★★ ELEVEN demands, 31 January 1930 , with a deadline of 11 March
"The Dandi march covered 240 miles in 78 days with 24 volunteers"	★★★ 78 volunteers, over 240 miles, 24 days, about 10 miles a day ; law broken at Dandi on 6 April
"About 10,000 were arrested during Civil Disobedience"	★★ About 100,000
"The Gandhi–Irwin Pact was signed in 1930"	★★ 5 March 1931 . The Congress had boycotted the FIRST Round Table Conference; Gandhi attended the second in December 1931
"Ambedkar founded the Depressed Classes Association in 1932"	★★ 1930 . The Poona Pact was September 1932

Trap	The truth
"The Poona Pact granted separate electorates to dalits"	★★★★ The opposite — reserved seats, but " voted in by the GENERAL electorate "
"Jinnah always insisted on separate electorates"	★★★ In 1927 he was willing to give them up for reserved seats in the Central Assembly and proportional representation in Bengal and Punjab ; talks collapsed at the All Parties Conference, 1928 , when M.R. Jayakar of the Hindu Mahasabha opposed compromise
"Vande Mataram was written by Rabindranath Tagore"	★★ Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay , in the 1870s , later in Anandamath . Abanindranath Tagore painted Bharat Mata ; Rabindranath collected ballads, nursery rhymes and myths
"The Swadeshi flag had a spinning wheel"	★★ Swadeshi flag (red, green, yellow) — eight lotuses and a crescent moon . ★ Swaraj flag (1921; red, green, white) — the spinning wheel
"The HSRA was founded in 1929 at Lahore"	★ 1928, Ferozeshah Kotla ground, Delhi . Bhagat Singh and Batukeswar Dutta bombed the Assembly in April 1929 ; Bhagat Singh was 23 when executed
"Quit India was launched at Wardha on 8 August"	★★ Resolution passed at WARDHA on 14 July 1942; endorsed by the AICC in BOMBAY on 8 August 1942 , with the " Do or Die " speech

● Mains angles

- ★★★★★ "List all the different social groups which joined the Non-Cooperation Movement of 1921. Then choose any three and write about their hopes and struggles." (NCERT's own question, and the template for a dozen others.) Groups: **urban middle class** (students, teachers, lawyers, merchants); **Awadh peasants**; **Gudem tribals**; **Assam plantation workers**. For each give **grievance** → **what swaraj meant** → **how it diverged from the Congress programme**.
- ★★★★★ "Why did various classes and groups of Indians participate in the Civil Disobedience Movement?" — Use the **four-column table** in §3.2 verbatim: rich peasants (revenue), poor tenants (rent), business classes (unrestricted trade), workers (wages, mostly aloof), women (sacred duty, symbolic role), dalits (limited participation, political solution sought elsewhere), Muslims (alienated). ★ **End on the structural point: the Congress could not satisfy rich peasants and poor tenants, or industrialists and workers, simultaneously**.
- ★★★★★ "Discuss the Salt March to make clear why it was an effective symbol of resistance against colonialism." — The **five-part answer** in §3.1: universality, necessity, making the abstract concrete after the failure of the 26 January pledge, availability to anyone, and putting the state in a lose-lose position. Add the **24 days of explaining swaraj at every halt**.
- ★★★★★ "Why did political leaders differ sharply over the question of SEPARATE ELECTORATES?" (NCERT's own question — and the highest-value answer in the chapter.) Set out **Gandhi's moral diagnosis** against **Ambedkar's political diagnosis**; the **fast unto death**; the **Poona Pact** and what each side won and lost; then **Iqbal's parallel argument** for Muslims and the **1928 near-miss with Jinnah**. ★ **Note the structural identity between Ambedkar's and Iqbal's reasoning — few candidates will**.
- ★★★★★ "Why is the growth of nationalism in the colonies linked to an anti-colonial movement?" — "**People began discovering their unity IN THE PROCESS of their struggle**"; the shared bond of oppression; but **varied experiences and varied notions of freedom**; and Ch.1's "**European ideas of nationalism were nowhere replicated**."
- ★★★★★ "How did the First World War help the growth of the national movement in India?" — Defence expenditure, **war loans**, **customs duties raised**, **income tax introduced**, **prices doubling 1913–18**, **forced recruitment**, crop failures of **1918-19 and 1920-21**, influenza, and ★ **12–13 million dead by the 1921 census**.
- ★★★★★ "What is meant by satyagraha?" — Truth-force; if the cause is just, physical force is unnecessary; **persuasion of the oppressor's conscience**, not coercion; ★ "**can be used only by the**

strong... it calls for intense activity"; and the strategic argument that a disarmed people cannot win by arms.

- ★★★★★ **"Why did Gandhiji decide to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement?"** — Chauri Chaura; the movement *"turning violent in many places"*; satyagrahis *"needed to be properly trained"*. ★ **Add the deeper reading: Awadh and Gudem showed the movement was being filled with meanings the Congress could not control.**
- ★★★★★ **"Compare the images of Bharat Mata and Germania."** (NCERT's own question — use the comparison table in §4, and end on the exclusion problem.)
- ★★★★★ **"Imagine you are a woman participating in Civil Disobedience."/"The role of women."** — Mass participation, marches, salt-making, picketing, jail; **but** high-caste and rich-peasant origins, **service framed as sacred duty rather than right, no positions of authority**, *"keen only on their symbolic presence."*
- ★★★★★ **Essay/GS1: "A nation with many voices."** — The whole chapter as one argument; end with the conclusion's own formulation.

Cross-links to build now

- ★★★★★ **Class 8 Ch.8** — everything before 1919: the early Congress, Moderates and Radicals, Bengal partition, Swadeshi, and the Pratapgarh peasants who credited Gandhi with their own achievements.
 - ★★★★★ **Ch.1 of this book** — *"nowhere replicated"*; Germania vs Bharat Mata; folklore and flags as nation-building; and **Frankfurt's failure to carry the workers** as the mirror-image of Gandhi taking the movement to the villages.
 - ★★★★★ **Class 9 Ch.4 and Ch.5** — the **forest grievance** behind Gudem, and the reserved forests violated during Civil Disobedience.
 - ★★★★★ **Class 9 supplement (Clothing)** — khadi's cost, the Swadeshi precedent, Gandhi's dress, **Ambedkar's suit**, the Gandhi cap.
 - ★★★★★ **Polity — Poona Pact → Articles 330/332**, reserved constituencies with a general electorate; and separate electorates as the constitutional question the Constituent Assembly finally closed.
-

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Forced recruitment	The colonial state forcing people to join the army
Satyagraha	Truth-force / soul-force — non-violent struggle that persuades the oppressor's conscience
Rowlatt Act (1919)	Allowed detention of political prisoners without trial for two years
Hartal	A general strike / shutdown of work and shops
Khilafat	Movement to defend the temporal powers of the Khalifa , the Ottoman emperor
Boycott	Refusal to deal, associate, participate, or buy and use things — as a form of protest
Picket	Blocking the entrance to a shop, factory or office as protest
Begar	Labour villagers were forced to contribute without payment
Nai-dhobi bandh	Panchayat-organised denial of barbers' and washermen's services to landlords
Talukdars	Landlords in Awadh demanding high rents and cesses
Inland Emigration Act, 1859	Barred plantation workers from leaving the tea gardens without permission
Purna Swaraj	Complete independence — adopted at Lahore, December 1929
Chaukidari tax	Village watchman tax, refused during Civil Disobedience
Gandhi-Irwin Pact	5 March 1931 — Congress to attend the second Round Table Conference; political prisoners released
Depressed Classes Association	Founded by Ambedkar, 1930
Poona Pact	September 1932 — reserved seats for the Depressed Classes, elected by the general electorate
Harijan	" <i>Children of God</i> " — Gandhi's term for the "untouchables"
Sanatanis	Conservative high-caste Hindus
HSRA	Hindustan Socialist Republican Army , founded 1928 at Ferozeshah Kotla
Swaraj flag (1921)	Red, green and white, with a spinning wheel
Bharat Mata	The female allegory of India — image first created by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay

60-Second Recap

- ★ ★ **The thesis:** nationalism in colonies grows with the anti-colonial movement; people "*discovered their unity in the process of their struggle*" — **but every group felt colonialism differently and meant something different by freedom**, so "*the unity did not emerge without conflict.*"
- ★ ★ **The war:** defence expenditure funded by **war loans, raised customs duties and a new income tax**; **prices doubled 1913–18**; **forced recruitment**; crop failures in **1918–19 and 1920–21**; influenza — and per the **1921 census, 12–13 million died**.
- ★ ★ **Gandhi returned January 1915** with **satyagraha** — "*pure soul-force*", which "*can be used only by the strong*" and "*calls for intense activity*", winning by **persuading the oppressor's conscience**. Early satyagrahas: ★ **Champaran 1917** (plantations), **Ahmedabad 1918** (mill workers), **Kheda 1918** (revenue relief after crop failure and plague).
- ★ ★ **The Rowlatt Act** allowed **detention without trial for two years**, passed "*despite the united opposition of the Indian members*"; **hartal 6 April 1919**; **Amritsar firing 10 April**; ★ **Jallianwala Bagh 13 April**, where Dyer **blocked the exits** and fired to "*produce a moral effect... a feeling of terror and awe.*"

Aftermath: satyagrahis made to **rub noses on the ground, crawl, salaam**; villages near **Gujranwala bombed**. **Gandhi called the movement off**.

5. ★★ **Khilafat** — because a movement confined to towns could not be national and *"no such movement could be organised without bringing the Hindus and Muslims closer together."* **Khilafat Committee, Bombay, March 1919**; the **Ali brothers**; Non-Cooperation agreed at **Calcutta, September 1920**, adopted at **Nagpur, December 1920** after *"an intense tussle."*
6. ★★ **Hind Swaraj (1909)**: British rule *"was established with the cooperation of Indians and survived only because of this cooperation"* — withdraw it and **rule collapses within a year**. Programme: **surrender titles; boycott civil services, army, police, courts, councils, schools, foreign goods**; then **full civil disobedience if repression came**.
7. ★★★ **In the towns**: students, teachers and lawyers withdrew; **councils boycotted except in Madras**, where the **Justice Party** entered them because they were the only route to power for **non-Brahmans**. **Foreign cloth imports halved 1921–22, Rs 102 crore → Rs 57 crore**. ★ It slowed because **khadi was dearer than mill cloth and because alternative Indian institutions were slow to come up**.
8. ★★★ **Awadh: Baba Ramchandra**, a sanyasi once indentured in **Fiji**; against **talukdars, begar and no security of tenure**; demands were **revenue reduction, abolition of begar and social boycott**, enforced by **nai–dhobi bandhs**. **Nehru toured from June 1920**; the **Oudh Kisan Sabha (Oct 1920)** had **300+ branches in a month**. Then houses were attacked and grain seized — ★ *"the name of the Mahatma was being invoked to sanction all action and aspirations."*
9. ★★★ **Gudem hills**: forests closed to grazing and gathering, **begar for road building**; **Alluri Sitaram Raju**, believed to survive bullets, **praised Gandhi and urged khadi and temperance while insisting India could be freed only by force; executed 1924**.
10. ★★★ **Assam plantations**: under the **Inland Emigration Act of 1859** workers could not leave; thousands walked out believing **"Gandhi Raj was coming and everyone would be given land"** — and were **stranded by a railway and steamer strike, caught and beaten**.
11. ★★★★★ **The resolution**: these visions *"were not defined by the Congress programme"* — **yet by acting in Gandhi's name they were "identifying with a movement which went beyond the limits of their immediate locality."**
12. ★★ **Withdrawal February 1922** after **Chauri Chaura**. Then the **Swaraj Party (C.R. Das, Motilal Nehru)** for council entry, against **Nehru and Bose** for radical agitation.
13. ★★ **The late 1920s**: agricultural prices **fell from 1926 and collapsed after 1930**; the **Simon Commission (1928) had no Indian member** — *"Go back Simon"*, and **Lala Lajpat Rai died of injuries**. **Irwin's vague dominion-status offer (Oct 1929)** satisfied no one; ★ **Lahore, December 1929**, adopted **Purna Swaraj** and declared **26 January 1930 Independence Day** — **but the celebrations "attracted very little attention."**
14. ★★★ **Salt: eleven demands to Irwin, 31 January 1930**, deadline **11 March**; salt chosen because it is *"consumed by the rich and the poor alike"* and its tax *"revealed the most oppressive face of British rule."* ★ **78 volunteers, 240+ miles, 24 days, ~10 miles a day, Sabarmati → Dandi, law broken 6 April**.
15. ★★ **Civil Disobedience meant BREAKING laws, not merely withdrawing**: salt manufactured, **revenue and chaukidari taxes refused**, village officials resigned, **forest laws violated**. **Peshawar firing after Ghaffar Khan's arrest**; **Sholapur workers attacked the symbols of rule; about 100,000 arrested**. ★ **Gandhi–Irwin Pact 5 March 1931**; second Round Table **December 1931** broke down; relaunched **1932**; **momentum lost by 1934**.
16. ★★★ **Participants: rich peasants (Patidars, Jats) wanted revenue cut and refused to rejoin in 1932** when it was not; **poor tenants wanted rent remitted** and the Congress **would not back "no rent"**; **business classes (FICCI 1927, Birla, Thakurdas) funded it for unrestricted trade** and cooled over **militancy and socialism**; **workers stayed largely aloof as industrialists came closer to the Congress**;

women participated in large numbers **but from high-caste and rich-peasant homes, as sacred duty, with "only symbolic presence."**

17. ★★★★★ **Dalits:** ignored by the Congress *"for fear of offending the sanatanis"*; Gandhi called untouchability a **sin**, coined **harijan**, led temple-entry satyagraha and **cleaned toilets** — while dalit leaders sought **reserved seats and separate electorates**, believing *"political empowerment would resolve their social disabilities."* **Ambedkar's Depressed Classes Association (1930)** clashed with Gandhi at the **second Round Table**; Britain conceded; **Gandhi fasted unto death**; the ★ **Poona Pact (September 1932)** gave **reserved seats voted by the general electorate** — and the **dalit movement remained apprehensive**.
18. ★★★★★ **Muslims:** alienated after Khilafat declined; the Congress **more visibly associated with the Hindu Mahasabha from the mid-1920s**; riots deepened distance. ★ **In 1927 Jinnah offered to drop separate electorates** for reserved seats and proportional representation in **Bengal and Punjab** — and the **1928 All Parties Conference collapsed when M.R. Jayakar of the Hindu Mahasabha opposed compromise**. **Iqbal (1930)** argued that *"the units of Indian society are not territorial as in European countries."*
19. ★★ **Collective belonging was manufactured: Bankim's Vande Mataram (1870s)** and *Anandamath*; **Abanindranath Tagore's ascetic Bharat Mata**; folklore revival by **Rabindranath** and **Natesa Sastri** (*The Folklore of Southern India*); the **Swadeshi flag** (eight lotuses, crescent) and the **Swaraj flag of 1921** (spinning wheel); and a **reinterpreted history of glory-then-decline**. ⚠️ *"When the past being glorified was Hindu... people of other communities felt left out."*
20. ★★ **Quit India:** after the **Cripps Mission** failed — resolution at **Wardha, 14 July 1942**, endorsed at **Bombay, 8 August 1942**, with **"Do or Die"**; **Jayprakash Narayan, Aruna Asaf Ali, Ram Manohar Lohia, Matangini Hazra, Kanaklata Barua, Rama Devi**; **over a year to suppress**.
21. ★★★★★ **The conclusion:** the Congress had to ensure *"the demands of one group did not alienate another"* — **"this is precisely why the unity within the movement often broke down"** — and what emerged was ★ **"a nation with many voices wanting freedom from colonial rule."**

Test Yourself

Prelims style

1. Arrange in order: (a) Jallianwala Bagh (b) Chauri Chaura (c) Dandi march (d) Poona Pact. — **a (Apr 1919) → b (Feb 1922) → c (Mar–Apr 1930) → d (Sept 1932)**.
2. The Rowlatt Act permitted — **detention of political prisoners without trial for two years**; it was passed **despite the united opposition of the Indian members** of the Imperial Legislative Council.
3. Consider: (i) Council elections were boycotted in all provinces. (ii) The Justice Party of Madras entered the councils. (iii) Foreign cloth imports halved between 1921 and 1922. — **(ii) and (iii) only**.
4. Baba Ramchandra and Alluri Sitaram Raju led movements respectively in — **Awadh and the Gudam hills of Andhra**; **Raju was executed in 1924**.
5. The Salt March covered — **over 240 miles in 24 days with 78 volunteers, from Sabarmati to Dandi, where the law was broken on 6 April 1930**.
6. Under the Poona Pact of September 1932, the Depressed Classes received — **reserved seats in provincial and central legislatures, but voted in by the GENERAL electorate** — not separate electorates.
7. Match: Swadeshi flag / Swaraj flag. — **Swadeshi (1905, red-green-yellow): eight lotuses and a crescent moon. Swaraj (1921, red-green-white): a spinning wheel**.

8. The "Do or Die" speech was delivered — **at Bombay on 8 August 1942**, when the AICC endorsed the Quit India resolution passed at **Wardha on 14 July 1942**.

Mains style

9. List the different social groups which joined the Non-Cooperation Movement of 1921. Choose any three and explain their hopes and struggles. **(250 words)** ★
10. Why did various classes and groups of Indians participate in the Civil Disobedience Movement? **(250 words)** ★
11. Discuss the Salt March to make clear why it was an effective symbol of resistance against colonialism. **(250 words)** ★
12. Why did political leaders differ sharply over the question of separate electorates? **(250 words)** ★ — *the highest-value question here*
13. How did the First World War help in the growth of the national movement in India? **(150 words)**
14. What is meant by the idea of satyagraha? Why did Gandhi call it active rather than passive resistance? **(150 words)**
15. Compare the image of Bharat Mata with that of Germania. **(150 words)**
16. "What was emerging was a nation with many voices wanting freedom from colonial rule." Discuss. **(250 words)** ★ — *Essay crossover*

Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- Give the war's effects on India with four figures.
- Define satyagraha as Gandhi did, and give his strategic argument for it.
- Name the three early satyagrahas with years and causes.
- Sequence 6, 10 and 13 April 1919 and say what happened on each.
- Explain in one sentence why Gandhi took up Khilafat — and its built-in weakness.
- Give the two reasons the town movement slowed.
- For four groups, state what swaraj meant to each.
- Give the five reasons salt was the perfect symbol.
- State Gandhi's and Ambedkar's diagnoses of untouchability, and what the Poona Pact settled.
- Explain the 1928 near-miss with Jinnah and why it failed.